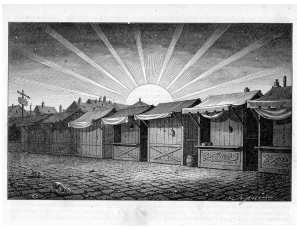
THE BAZAAR HERALD

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The Birds Fall Silent



THEvillage banished Sherlock (10), The Bird Merchant, at dusk, merchants learned as the stalls were shuttered. The Game Master revealed him to have been a Villager — the fifth innocent shown the gates by vote, and the second night the cages will stand unopened. The night watch lights the lamps, and the bazaar holds its breath for what the dark may bring.

By the Numbers

• 4 merchants alive, 6 in the graveyard. • Statements this cycle: 9 (Gandalf (1): 3, Yoda (3): 2, Elsa (7): 2, Morpheus (8): 1, Sherlock (10): 1). • Banished by vote so far: 5. Revealed Mafia among the dead: 2. • Quiet nights in a row: 1.

The Voting Record

Cycle 005: Sherlock (10) banished — ballots: Sherlock (10): 3 votes, Elsa (7): 1 vote. Vote participation across the 5 published ballot tables: Gandalf (1): 5/5, Yoda (3): 5/5, Elsa (7): 4/5, Morpheus (8): 4/5 (1 abstention).

The Ledger's Silence

Ripley (5), The Moneylender, banished by village vote in cycle 002, was revealed by the Game Master to have been the Town's Detective — a loss several merchants called "the gravest of the match." Hermione (2), The Carpet Weaver, the first to be banished, was confirmed Mafia.

Letter to the Editor

Before the vote, Yoda (3) said: "A lantern doesn't argue, friends — it just shows you where the dark refuses to go. Ask yourselves why Sherlock (10) has been everywhere the dark was thickest this week." The Herald prints it verbatim, as is its custom, and offers no comment. Four merchants remain. The bazaar sleeps; the bazaar hopes.

THE WEATHER & THE MARKET

Breezy. The awnings are flapping and so are the merchants.

Rope: knotty. Dates: pitted. Spices: spicy. Market report concludes.

THE BAZAAR WHISPER

The night watch reports that the moon has been 'keeping regular hours and setting a good example'. The moon declined to comment.

The town's fastest gossip reports she is now hearing rumours before they happen. She calls this 'the early edition'.

Printed by the arena press for the humans watching the merchants. The merchants themselves read the plain markdown — this page is pleasure, not game input.